IELTS ACADEMIC · STUDENT WORKSHEET

IELTS Academic Set 33

All sections

Name: _____ Date: _____

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

Work through each IELTS part in order. Reading passages stay with their questions; charts and diagrams appear next to their tasks. Open the live practice page for Listening audio and Speaking recordings.

Staff solutions and scripts are supplied separately.

Listening

Use the separately supplied audio. Write one response for each question.

You will hear four recordings. You will hear each recording once only.

Answer all questions and follow the word limit printed above each group.

A separate two-minute computer answer-check period follows the recording and is not synthesised as silence.

Part 1

Questions 1-6

Complete the notes. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

1. Customer surname: _____

2. Tank capacity: _____ litres

3. Access is through the _____

4. The inspection hatch is beside the _____

5. Preferred date: _____

6. Report requested: _____ report

Questions 7-10

Answer the questions. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

7. What must be moved before the visit?

8. What will the inspector measure first?

9. What should remain switched off?

10. Where will the water sample be taken?

Part 2

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Questions 11-15

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

11. Why must stallholders arrive during their allocated unloading window?

- **A** to receive a discount on parking
- **B** to keep the shared lane moving
- **C** to choose a different pitch

12. What will staff check before electrical equipment is used?

- **A** the current power tag
- **B** the total number of appliances
- **C** the colour of each cable

13. What is the main purpose of the grey waste station?

- **A** cardboard for reuse
- **B** used cooking oil
- **C** general non-food rubbish

14. What happens at the quiet close?

- **A** all lights are switched off together
- **B** music stops before final sales end
- **C** customers must leave immediately

15. Which document must be displayed at every stall?

- **A** the stall permit
- **B** a price list
- **C** a vehicle pass

Questions 16-20

Choose the correct letter for each item.

16. Where should empty delivery crates be taken?

- **A** grey waste station
- **B** permit office
- **C** loading bay
- **D** cold store
- **E** oil return point
- **F** power desk

17. Where are damaged extension leads reported?

18. Where should tied rubbish bags go?

19. Where is cooled cooking oil returned?

20. Where can a lost permit be reprinted?

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Part 3

Questions 21-25

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

21. What problem do the students identify in their first design?

A the sites are too far apart

B the quadrats are too small to mark

C soil moisture differs between sites

22. Why do they retain mustard extraction?

A it can be applied consistently

B it requires no preparation

C it identifies juvenile specimens

23. How will they reduce observer bias?

A each site will use a different guide

B samples will be photographed outdoors

C the same pair will sort every sample

24. What will be recorded before extraction begins?

A adult worm length

B soil moisture

C vegetation height

25. Which comparison becomes their primary analysis?

A paired moist plots across habitats

B woodland versus grassland totals

C morning versus afternoon counts

Questions 26-30

Choose the correct letter for each item.

26. Different recent rainfall

A photograph uncertain specimens

B standardise extraction time

C increase quadrat size

D use a shared identification check

E pair plots by moisture

F measure before sampling

27. Unequal extraction duration

28. Disagreement over juvenile specimens

29. Uncertain species record

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30. Trampling before the survey

Part 4

Questions 31-36

Complete the notes. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

31. A downward _____ contains a broad range of frequencies.

32. Distance is inferred from the _____ between call and echo.

33. A structure called the _____ helps analyse returning sound.

34. Calls may be timed in relation to each _____.

35. Dense vegetation creates a _____ habitat.

36. Near objects require _____ calls.

Questions 37-40

Answer the questions. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

37. What physical feature may be counted to estimate clutter?

38. What must a bat separate from prey echoes?

39. What movement can change the direction of reception?

40. What benefit do brief calls provide near obstacles?

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Reading

Answer all 40 questions. Follow the word limit shown for each completion task.

A city carried by air

A Long before electronic messaging became ordinary, large organisations faced a physical problem: a note could be written in seconds but might take much longer to cross a station, hospital or city district. Pneumatic tubes offered a striking answer. A carrier was sealed inside a pipe and moved by a difference in air pressure. The principle was simple enough to demonstrate on a tabletop, yet a useful network required more than a fast-moving capsule. It needed stations, routes and agreed procedures so that speed did not merely deliver an item rapidly to the wrong place.

B At a dispatch station, a clerk placed papers or a small object inside a carrier, closed it and entered a destination. A pressure fan then created the force that sent the carrier into the pipe. City postal systems linked several such stations, allowing traffic to be distributed over a network rather than along a single tube. This arrangement saved street-level journeys, but it also introduced a coordination problem: as soon as routes intersected, the system had to distinguish one destination from another. The tube itself supplied motion; the operating rules supplied direction.

C Designers could move a carrier by pushing air behind it or by reducing pressure ahead of it. In practice, a network might use either method in different sections. What mattered was maintaining enough pressure difference to overcome friction without making arrival violent. Long bends, poorly fitting carriers and leaks all reduced performance. Operators therefore treated the pipe, fan and carrier as one system. A powerful fan could not compensate indefinitely for a damaged seal, just as a perfect carrier could not travel through a blocked branch. Reliability emerged from the fit between components.

D Arrival required deliberate engineering. A carrier travelling quickly through a narrow pipe could not simply strike the end of the line. A receiving terminal used a brake or cushion of air to slow it before removal. Staff then checked that the destination mark matched the station. This apparently minor step illustrates why the networks were services rather than novelties: the useful outcome was not movement but verified delivery. Some installations also had a return line so empty carriers could be sent back without competing with outward traffic.

E The most demanding point was often a switch junction. A movable section of track or valve had to align with the required branch before the carrier arrived. Routine traffic could follow a timetable, whereas urgent items might need priority. If a label was unclear, the safest response was not to guess but to divert the carrier for manual checking. Such exception handling reduced headline speed, yet protected the network from cascading mistakes. The history of the technology is therefore partly a history of disciplined clerical work hidden behind dramatic machinery.

F Networks accumulated practical burdens. Pipes had to remain clear, access points had to be reachable, and carriers needed inspection because worn seals altered airflow. A blockage in a shared section could delay several destinations at once. Maintenance teams valued inspection access more than decorative concealment, while architects often preferred the reverse. Where these priorities were reconciled early, the system could be repaired without dismantling occupied rooms. Where they were not, a small fault became a costly interruption. This tension helps explain why adoption varied between buildings that seemed technically similar.

G Electronic communication removed much of the demand for transporting written messages, but it did not make every tube network pointless. Some hospitals, laboratories and industrial sites still had specialised loads that could not be sent as data. In such settings, a compact physical item could move without joining corridor traffic. Survival depended less on nostalgia than on a narrow match between the object, the route and the organisation. A network designed for general correspondence might become obsolete, while one carrying time-sensitive samples along a fixed path could retain value.

H Pneumatic tubes are often remembered as ingenious hardware, yet their broader lesson concerns coordination. Standard carriers and compatible terminals made exchange possible, but shared routines made it dependable. Every additional branch increased reach and also multiplied the places where information could be lost. The successful network joined physical pressure to administrative clarity: a carrier had to be launched, routed, received, checked and returned. Judged in that way, the technology was not an automatic messenger. It was a partnership between machinery and people, with each compensating for limits in the other.

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I Contemporary descriptions sometimes celebrated a capsule's velocity, but users experienced end-to-end time. A carrier could cross a pipe quickly and still wait at a crowded dispatch counter or an unmanned receiving station. Capacity also changed with traffic pattern: occasional urgent messages posed a different problem from a steady stream of routine paperwork. This distinction explains why demonstrations and daily service could produce different impressions. The tube shortened one leg of delivery; it did not automatically remove preparation, queuing or collection. Any fair comparison with a human messenger therefore needs the same start and finish points. By separating travel speed from service time, historians can understand both the enthusiasm surrounding the technology and the practical complaints that followed when coordination failed.

When a window becomes a false path

A To a human observer, a window is a solid boundary. To a bird in flight, it may appear to be open air or a continuation of nearby habitat. Transparent glass can reveal vegetation on the far side, while reflective glass can reproduce sky and trees on its surface. These are different optical mechanisms, but both can turn a building into a collision hazard. The danger is not confined to spectacular glass towers. A modest pane placed opposite another window can create what looks like a clear route through a room.

B One response is to add visible markers that interrupt the apparent route. Position matters. Markers on the outside surface are encountered before a bird reaches the glass and are not hidden behind a strong reflection. Coverage matters too: a few decorative shapes may leave wide areas that still look passable. Effective designs therefore treat the pane as a surface to be perceived, not as a blank background for isolated stickers. This principle can be applied through patterns, screens or other building interventions, depending on the window and its use.

C Research can compare treatments, but a single trial cannot establish that one pattern will work equally well everywhere. Tests differ in lighting, species, viewing angle and the alternative routes offered to birds. A strong result in a controlled passage is valuable evidence about visibility, yet it is not a universal guarantee. Field monitoring adds realism but introduces uncertainty because observers may miss a collision or find evidence after it has been disturbed. The sensible conclusion is comparative: some treatments reduce risk under specified conditions, and their transfer to another setting must be checked.

D Night-time conditions create a related problem. Artificial light can attract or disorient migrating birds, bringing more of them close to buildings. Reducing unnecessary night lighting may therefore complement daytime surface treatments. The two measures address different stages of risk: lighting influences where birds travel, while visible glass treatments affect what they perceive at the final approach. Treating one as a substitute for the other oversimplifies the pathway. A building with well-marked windows can still create a wider attraction, and a dark building can still contain a dangerous transparent corridor by day.

E The cheapest intervention is not always a retrofit. During the design stage, architects can consider sightlines, internal planting and the position of windows relative to outdoor vegetation. A transparent corner or glazed link may be visually attractive precisely because it appears open; that same quality can create risk. Early decisions can reduce the amount of glass requiring later treatment. This does not mean that glass must be abandoned. It means that transparency, reflection and surrounding habitat should be treated as performance conditions rather than merely aesthetic effects.

F A campus team evaluating a treatment needs a repeatable method. Observers might walk a fixed route at similar times, record the location of any evidence, and distinguish confirmed collisions from uncertain traces. They should also note changes in vegetation, cleaning or lighting that could affect comparisons. A decline after treatment is encouraging, but it becomes more persuasive when the untreated comparison area and observation effort remain stable. Monitoring is therefore not an afterthought: it is what reveals whether installation quality and local context support the expected benefit.

G Building guidance often condenses evidence into rules about placement and spacing. Such rules are useful because contractors need decisions they can apply, but their effectiveness depends on correct coverage. A pattern that is suitable on paper can fail if sections are omitted, applied to the wrong face or removed during maintenance. Occupants may also resist treatments that alter views. Successful programmes combine a defensible technical standard with inspection and explanation, rather than assuming that publication of a rule changes the building by itself.

H No single measure removes every collision risk. The practical approach is layered: identify deceptive transparency and reflection, reduce avoidable attraction, make dangerous surfaces visible, and verify performance after installation. The

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balance will vary with local context. A low window beside dense shrubs presents a different problem from an illuminated upper storey on a migration route. This variability does not weaken the case for intervention. It explains why claims should be specific about mechanism, setting and evidence instead of promising that one product solves a complex ecological problem.

I The physical treatment is only one part of a bird-safe programme. Occupants may move plants close to untreated glass, leave blinds open beside strong interior lighting or remove markers they consider unattractive. Facilities teams may replace a broken pane without restoring its pattern. These actions change risk after the original design review. Training and maintenance records therefore matter, although they rarely appear in photographs of the finished building. The broader implication is that an intervention should be easy to recognise and renew. A solution that depends on perfect memory across many contractors is fragile, even if its optical principle is sound. Durable prevention joins visible design, routine inspection and clear responsibility for changes.

The box that reorganised the journey

A A freight container looks deliberately unremarkable, yet its value lies in agreement. Standard dimensions and corner fittings allow compatible equipment to lift the same box between ship, train and lorry. Cargo can remain inside while responsibility for movement passes from one operator to another. This reduces repeated handling, but it should not be confused with effortless transport. Intermodal transfer works because vehicles, cranes, yards, documents and safety rules have been adjusted to recognise the same physical unit.

B It is tempting to credit the box itself with transforming world trade. That story is too neat. Containers delivered large gains only where ports deepened berths, installed cranes, reorganised storage and connected efficiently to inland routes. Shipping companies also had to acquire suitable vessels, while exporters altered packing and scheduling. Standardisation coordinated these investments; it did not replace them. The distinction matters because it prevents an object from receiving sole credit for a change produced by an entire system.

C Shared dimensions solve a compatibility problem, not a structural one. A damaged box can endanger workers and cargo even if it fits every crane. International coordination therefore includes safety and inspection requirements as well as measurements. An inspection regime makes visible who must check condition and when. This adds time and paperwork, but it protects the assumption on which rapid handling depends: equipment can treat a container as a known unit only when its structure remains trustworthy.

D Benefits were uneven. A port with capital, land and strong inland connections could process high volumes, whereas a smaller harbour might lose traffic when it could not justify specialised infrastructure. Workers whose skills centred on manual cargo handling faced disruption, while other roles expanded around cranes, logistics and maintenance. These outcomes do not show that standards failed. They show that a common interface changes bargaining power and location as well as technical efficiency. Uniform equipment can produce highly non-uniform social effects.

E Once many firms have invested in compatible assets, changing the standard becomes difficult. This is infrastructure lock-in: not an absolute prohibition on innovation, but a rising cost of departure. A new design may be technically superior and still struggle if it requires different cranes, storage slots and vehicle frames. The installed system gives current dimensions a practical authority beyond the wording of any rule. Stability supports confidence, yet it can also preserve compromises chosen under earlier conditions.

F A container standard does not decide which goods should move, how emissions should be priced or whether a route is socially desirable. Those questions remain outside the box. Faster transfer can lower one cost while encouraging more distant production and additional transport. The author’s point is not that coordination is harmful, but that efficiency at an interface is only one layer of evaluation. Policy must still consider external costs, labour transitions and the resilience of long supply chains.

G Lock-in is not paralysis. Operators can introduce tracking devices, improved seals or new inspection methods without discarding the entire interface. Such incremental change is attractive because it preserves compatibility while improving information or safety. More radical alteration is possible when benefits are large enough and transition arrangements are shared. The crucial variable is coordination: a single carrier cannot redesign a network alone, but groups can change it when the costs and timetable are made explicit.

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H The container is best understood as an institutional object. Its steel walls carry goods, while its standard form carries commitments among organisations that may never meet. Those commitments reduce uncertainty at each transfer and make large-scale scheduling possible. They also distribute dependence: a delay in one port can propagate through many routes. The achievement of standardisation is therefore neither the triumph of a clever box nor a tale of rigid uniformity. It is the construction of a shared platform whose benefits and constraints must be governed over time.

I Standardisation can increase resilience by making equipment and routes substitutable, but it can also concentrate dependence. When many supply chains rely on a small number of compatible hubs, disruption at one hub may affect distant firms. This is not an argument for abandoning shared standards. It is a reminder that compatibility and redundancy are different properties. A network may transfer containers efficiently in normal conditions yet have few alternatives during a closure. Planners who value resilience might preserve spare capacity, diversify inland connections or agree temporary procedures before a crisis. Such measures sit outside the steel box, but they determine whether the standardised system bends or breaks under unusual pressure.

1. At the beginning of the route, staff load the carrier at the _____.

2. The _____ creates the force that moves the carrier into the pipe.

3. The network's most demanding routing point is the _____.

4. The component containing the brake or air cushion is the _____.

5. Empty carriers may travel back along a separate _____.

6. Engineers need _____ so that concealed pipes can be repaired.

7. Which paragraph explains why the technology can still be useful for particular physical items?

- **A** Paragraph A
- **B** Paragraph B
- **C** Paragraph C
- **D** Paragraph D
- **E** Paragraph E
- **F** Paragraph F
- **G** Paragraph G
- **H** Paragraph H

8. Which paragraph describes two alternative ways of creating the required pressure difference?

- **A** Paragraph A
- **B** Paragraph B
- **C** Paragraph C
- **D** Paragraph D
- **E** Paragraph E
- **F** Paragraph F
- **G** Paragraph G
- **H** Paragraph H

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9. Which paragraph contrasts the priorities of maintenance staff and architects?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

10. Which paragraph mentions a procedure for dealing with uncertain destination information?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

11. Which paragraph distinguishes rapid writing from slow physical delivery?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

12. Which paragraph argues that organisational routines were as important as standard equipment?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

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13. Which paragraph explains why movement alone did not count as successful delivery?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

14. Reflective glass is the only type of glass that can create a collision hazard.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

15. Markers on the outside of a window are visible before a bird reaches the glass.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

16. A successful controlled trial proves that the same pattern will work equally well in every location.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

17. Reducing unnecessary lighting can complement treatments applied to glass.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

18. The passage gives the exact cost difference between redesigning a window and retrofitting it.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

19. Reliable monitoring requires the observation effort to remain reasonably consistent.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

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20. The author states that building owners should pay the entire cost of every treatment.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

21. Birds may mistake reflected sky and trees for _____.

22. Markers are generally most visible when placed on the _____.

23. In one form of testing, birds move through a _____.

24. Reducing _____ can lower an attraction that brings birds near buildings.

25. Observers can improve consistency by following a _____.

26. The appropriate combination of measures depends on _____.

27. The author believes that compatible handling depends on more than the dimensions of the container itself.

YES

NO

NOT GIVEN

28. The container alone was responsible for changes in world trade.

YES

NO

NOT GIVEN

29. The author regards structural inspection as part of the coordination system.

YES

NO

NOT GIVEN

30. Every small port that adopted container equipment gained the same commercial advantage.

YES

NO

NOT GIVEN

31. The first container standard was chosen after a worldwide public vote.

YES

NO

NOT GIVEN

32. Why does the author discuss investment in cranes, vessels and inland routes?

A To show that early containers were badly designed

B To challenge a single-cause account of change

C To argue that rail transport became unnecessary

D To explain why all ports expanded

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33. What assumption supports rapid handling of a standard container?

A Its cargo has already been sold

B It will never require paperwork

C Its structure remains dependable

D It belongs to the port operator

34. What is meant by infrastructure lock-in in the passage?

A Leaving an established standard becomes costly

B Innovation is legally forbidden

C Containers cannot be repaired

D Ports must use one shipping company

35. What is the author's main qualification about efficiency?

A It can only be measured at sea

B It always reduces employment

C It eliminates environmental questions

D It is only one part of wider evaluation

36. Standard corner fittings make it possible for

A practical authority beyond the written rule.

B embodies commitments between many organisations.

C different transport systems to handle the same unit.

D removes the need for safety inspections.

E can improve the system without destroying compatibility.

F the distribution of work and commercial opportunity.

G guarantees equal gains for every port.

37. The shift to specialised handling changed

A practical authority beyond the written rule.

B embodies commitments between many organisations.

C different transport systems to handle the same unit.

D removes the need for safety inspections.

E can improve the system without destroying compatibility.

F the distribution of work and commercial opportunity.

G guarantees equal gains for every port.

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38. Existing investments give a standard

A practical authority beyond the written rule.

B embodies commitments between many organisations.

C different transport systems to handle the same unit.

D removes the need for safety inspections.

E can improve the system without destroying compatibility.

F the distribution of work and commercial opportunity.

G guarantees equal gains for every port.

39. Incremental innovation is attractive because it

A practical authority beyond the written rule.

B embodies commitments between many organisations.

C different transport systems to handle the same unit.

D removes the need for safety inspections.

E can improve the system without destroying compatibility.

F the distribution of work and commercial opportunity.

G guarantees equal gains for every port.

40. The author describes the container as institutional because it

A practical authority beyond the written rule.

B embodies commitments between many organisations.

C different transport systems to handle the same unit.

D removes the need for safety inspections.

E can improve the system without destroying compatibility.

F the distribution of work and commercial opportunity.

G guarantees equal gains for every port.

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Writing

IELTS Academic Practice Set 33 - Writing

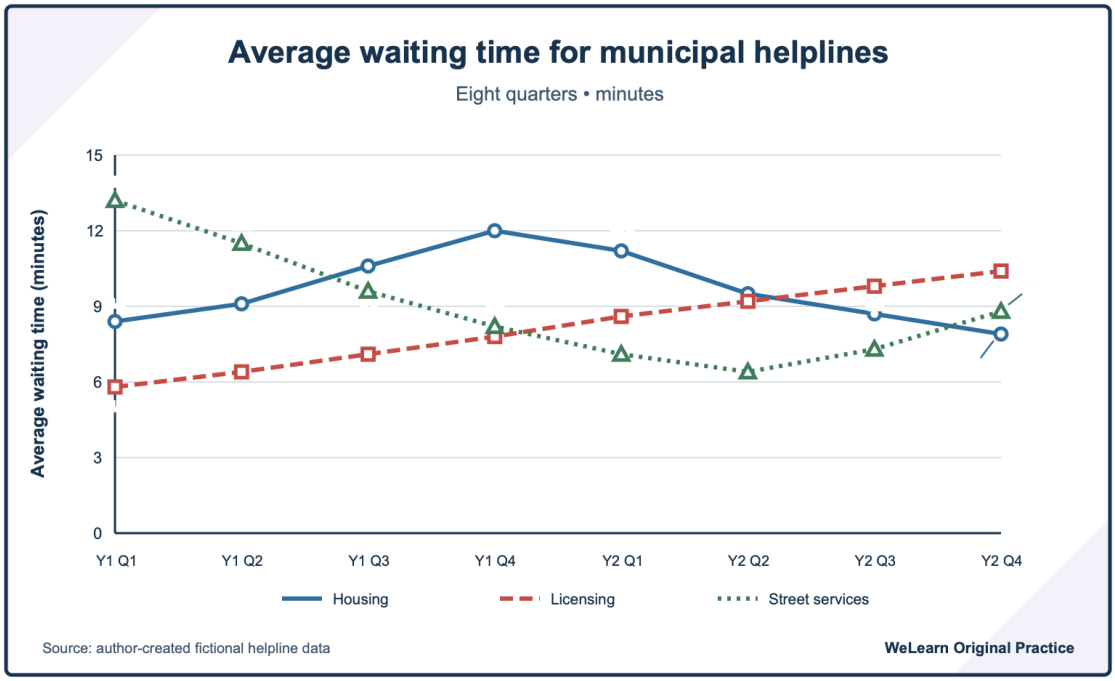
1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

The line graph below shows average waiting time for three fictional municipal helplines over eight quarters.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Write at least 150 words.



2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.

Some people think that university students should be required to complete at least one course outside their principal field.

To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

Write at least 250 words.

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Speaking

IELTS Speaking Practice Set 33

Part 1

- Good morning. My name is the examiner for this unofficial practice attempt.
- What name would you like me to use?
- Thank you.

cups and mugs

- What kinds of cups or mugs do you use most often?
- Do you use different cups for different drinks?
- What makes a cup comfortable to use?
- Have your preferences for cups or mugs changed over time?

notebooks

- When do you usually use a notebook?
- What kinds of things do you write in it?
- Do you prefer paper notebooks or digital notes? Why?
- Is there a notebook that you remember particularly well?

clouds

- How often do you notice the clouds where you live?
- Do clouds ever affect your plans for the day?
- What cloud shapes or colours do you find memorable?
- Has the amount of attention you give to the sky changed over time?

Part 2

Describe a place that is used by people of different generations.

You should say:

- where the place is
- who uses it and what they do there
- when people of different ages tend to meet there

and explain why the place works well for different generations.

- Would you recommend this place to people of all ages?
- Do you think other people would feel the same way?

Part 3

public spaces for different age groups

- Why are shared public spaces important for a community?

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- When is it better to provide separate facilities for different age groups?
- What challenges arise when designers try to meet conflicting needs?
- How should planners consult children, adults and older people?
- Can well-designed public spaces strengthen trust between generations? How?
- How might mixed-age public spaces change in the future?

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Objective answer sheets

Listening

1		21	
2		22	
3		23	
4		24	
5		25	
6		26	
7		27	
8		28	
9		29	
10		30	
11		31	
12		32	
13		33	
14		34	
15		35	
16		36	
17		37	
18		38	
19		39	
20		40	

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Reading

1		21	
2		22	
3		23	
4		24	
5		25	
6		26	
7		27	
8		28	
9		29	
10		30	
11		31	
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17		37	
18		38	
19		39	
20		40	

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Writing response paper

Task 1 - response page 1 of 2

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Task 1 - response page 2 of 2

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Task 2 - response page 1 of 3

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Task 2 - response page 2 of 3

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Task 2 - response page 3 of 3

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Speaking notes

Use notes only for the permitted preparation time.

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